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Hiring Team, Confidential Startup (via Talent Toppers)

At PriceKeel, the company I founded, I set the operating rhythm myself: I run the CRM and CPQ, sit in the forecast and pipeline reviews, sign off on deal approvals, and built the investor narrative now carrying the company through its first fundraising round. Nobody assigned any of that structure; I built it because a growing company needed it and there was no one else to own it. That is what acting as a force multiplier for a CEO actually means in practice: not analysis handed up the chain, but a decision pushed through without anyone telling you how.

Before PriceKeel, I partnered with senior executives at Sensata on AP26 revenue models and site-transition strategy for a multi-$100M Industrial BU, building the leadership decks and running the OKR cadence, weekly and quarterly business reviews, that kept that work visible to the people making the call. I also led the Bleeders and Leakers program end to end: built a Power BI system that ranked 1,200 pricing opportunities against a $627M target, then closed $700K+ of that gap in 2 quarters through negotiations with Sales and Finance I had no formal authority to compel. That is the same muscle a CEO's office runs on: briefing materials sharp enough for a board or an investor, and enough judgment to move a cross-functional room toward a decision.

At Applied Materials now, I turn ambiguous field input from Sales, Engineering and Accounts into one market view, carrying P&L and revenue targets for the role with no formal authority over any of those teams. I automate the repetitive half of that analysis with AI agents built on Claude, not because the tool is the point but because the actual job is the judgment call at the end of the pivot table, and that time should go toward the decision, not the formatting.

On the people side, I have hired and managed teams directly: an 8-person account team at Pixis running 8 client relationships, and the team behind SwipeHire, an AI job-matching platform I built zero-to-one. Operating rhythm, cross-functional execution without a title to lean on, board-ready materials, and the hiring and culture work that comes with scaling a team, I have already run all four, just at a different company's scale each time. Proof trail at adhithyabhaskar.vercel.app/ref/talent-toppers.

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